

DIVINE WORD COLLEGE OF CALAPAN

School of Engineering

METHODS OF RESEARCH

Chapter 1: The Problem and Its Setting

This chapter introduces the research topic, providing background information and context. It establishes the significance of the study and identifies the research problem. It also presents the study's scope and delimitations.

- **Sections:**

- **Introduction:** Briefly introduce the research topic and its relevance.
- **Background of the Study:** Provide a more detailed context, including relevant statistics, trends, and existing problems.
- **Theoretical Framework:** Discuss the theories that underpin the research.
- **Conceptual Framework:** Present a visual or narrative description of the main concepts and relationships in the study.
- **Statement of the Problem:** Clearly and concisely state the main research question or problem that the study aims to address.
- **Objectives of the Study:** State the specific goals and aims of the research.
- **Significance of the Study:** Explain why the research is important and who will benefit from it.
- **Scope and Delimitation:** Define the boundaries of the research, including what will and will not be covered.
- **Definition of Terms:** Define key terms used in the study.

- **Tips:**

- Start with a broad overview and gradually narrow down to the specific research focus.
- Provide relevant statistics and evidence to support the importance of the problem.
- Ensure that the research problem is clearly defined and aligned with the objectives.
- Be clear and concise in defining key terms.

Chapter 2: Review of Related Literature

This chapter presents a comprehensive review of existing literature and studies relevant to the research topic. It provides a theoretical framework for the study and identifies gaps in the literature that the research aims to fill.

- **Sections:**

- **Introduction:** Briefly introduce the purpose of the literature review.
- **Related Literature:** Present a thematic review of relevant studies, theories, and concepts.
- **Synthesis:** Summarize the literature review and identify gaps that the current study will address.

- **Tips:**

- Organize the literature review thematically or by topic.
- Critically analyze and synthesize the literature, rather than simply summarizing it.
- Clearly explain how the literature relates to the research problem and objectives.
- Identify conflicting findings or gaps in the literature.

Chapter 3: Research Methodology

This chapter describes the research design and the methods used to conduct the study. It explains how data was collected and analyzed.

- **Sections:**

- **Research Design:** Describe the overall approach and design of the study (e.g., descriptive, correlational, experimental).
- **Respondents of the Study:** Describe the target population and the sample used in the study.
- **Research Instrument:** Describe the data collection tools used (e.g., questionnaires, interviews, observation protocols).
- **Data Collection Procedure:** Explain the steps involved in collecting the data.
- **Data Analysis:** Describe the statistical or qualitative techniques used to analyze the data.
- **Ethical Considerations:** Discuss how ethical principles were addressed in the study (e.g., informed consent, confidentiality).

- **Tips:**

- Clearly justify the choice of research design and methods.
- Provide detailed information about the participants, instruments, and procedures to ensure replicability.
- Explain how the data analysis methods are appropriate for the research questions.
- Address potential sources of bias and limitations of the study.
- Thoroughly discuss ethical considerations.

Chapter 4: Presentation, Analysis, and Interpretation of Data

This chapter presents the findings of the study in a clear and organized manner. It includes tables, figures, and textual descriptions of the data. It also involves analyzing and interpreting the data in relation to the research questions and objectives.

- **Sections:**

- **Introduction:** Briefly introduce the chapter and its purpose.
- **Presentation of Data:** Present the findings using tables, figures, and text.
- **Analysis of Data:** Analyze the data in relation to the research questions and objectives.
- **Interpretation of Data:** Explain the meaning and significance of the findings.

- **Tips:**
 - Present the data in a clear, concise, and organized manner.
 - Use tables and figures effectively to summarize and illustrate key findings.
 - Provide a thorough and objective analysis of the data.
 - Interpret the findings in the context of the literature review and theoretical framework.
 - Discuss the implications of the findings for theory and practice.

Chapter 5: Summary of Findings, Conclusions, and Recommendations

This chapter provides a summary of the main findings of the study. It draws conclusions based on the findings and offers recommendations for future research or practice.

- **Sections:**
 - **Summary of Findings:** Briefly summarize the key findings of the study.
 - **Conclusions:** Draw logical conclusions based on the findings.
 - **Recommendations:** Offer specific and actionable recommendations for future research, policy, or practice.
- **Tips:**
 - Ensure that the summary of findings accurately reflects the data presented in Chapter 4.
 - Draw conclusions that are directly supported by the findings.
 - Avoid making generalizations that are not supported by the data.
 - Provide clear and practical recommendations.
 - Discuss the limitations of the study and suggest areas for future research.

References

The References section is a crucial component of a research paper. It provides a comprehensive list of all the sources cited within the text, allowing readers to verify the information and explore the cited works in more detail. Here's a guide on how to write it:

- **Purpose:**
 - To give credit to the original authors of the ideas and information used in the research.
 - To allow readers to locate and consult the cited sources.
 - To demonstrate the breadth and depth of the research.
- **Placement:**
 - The References section is always placed at the end of the paper, after the concluding chapter (Chapter 5 in this format).
- **Formatting:**
 - **Consistency:** Use a consistent citation style throughout the paper (e.g., APA, MLA, Chicago). The APA style is used in the institution.
 - **Heading:** The section should be titled "References" (or "Works Cited" in MLA style).
 - **Alphabetical Order:** List all references in alphabetical order by the first author's last name.
 - **Hanging Indentation:** Use a hanging indent for each reference entry. The first line of

each entry is flush left, and subsequent lines are indented.

- **Double-Spacing:** The entire References section should be double-spaced.
- **Content:**
 - Include only the sources that are cited in the body of the paper. Do not include sources that were consulted but not actually cited.
 - Provide complete and accurate information for each source, including:
 - Author's name(s)
 - Year of publication
 - Title of the work
 - Publication information (e.g., journal name, volume, issue, page numbers; publisher, city)
 - DOI (if available)
- **Examples (APA Style):**
 - **Journal Article:**
 - Author, A. A., Author, B. B., & Author, C. C. (Year). Title of article. *Title of Periodical*, volume number(issue number), pages. DOI or URL
 - Example: Weiss, C. H. (1997). Theory-based evaluation: Past, present and future. *New Directions for Evaluation*, 76, 41-55.
 - **Book:**
 - Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of work*. Publisher.
 - Example: Department of Trade and Industry (DTI), (2018). *An Annual Review of Small Business in South Africa, (2017-2018)*. DTI.
 - **Edited Book Chapter:**
 - Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of chapter. In A. Editor, B. Editor, & C. Editor (Eds.), *Title of work* (pages). Publisher.
 - **Webpage:**
 - Author, A. A. (Year, Month, Day). *Title of page*. Site Name. URL
 - Example: National Innovation System (NIS) 2019. PHILIPPINES: *Assessing the Effectiveness of MSME and Entrepreneurship Support*. Finance, Competitiveness and Innovation Global Practice. <https://undg.org/wp-...>
- **Tips for Accuracy:**
 - **Double-Check:** Accuracy is paramount. Carefully check all details against the original sources.
 - **Use a Citation Manager:** Consider using citation management software (e.g., Zotero, Mendeley, EndNote) to organize your sources and generate accurate citations.
 - **Consult a Style Guide:** Refer to the official APA Publication Manual or the relevant style guide for detailed formatting rules and examples.

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